Circle the correct answer for each question. If you're unsure, you can write numbers 1, 2, 3, etc. next to the choices to get partial credit. Questions refer to the nonindented paragraph above unless otherwise stated.

Sickle-cell disease is a painful disorder of the red blood cells. To investigate whether drug A can reduce the pain associated with sickle-cell disease, a study by the National Institutes of Health randomly assigned 150 sickle-cell sufferers to receive the drug. Placebos were given to another 150 sickle-cell sufferers. Great care was used to ensure that the 300 participants did not know if their pill contained the drug. At the end of the treatment period, the researchers counted the number of episodes of pain reported by each subject.

1. Which of the following principles was NOT used in this study?

   (a) Randomization
   (b) Control group
   (c) Blinding
   (d) Blocking

   Correct answers: (d)

Whirling disease is a deadly disease that affects trout in Montana rivers. In a follow-up to a 2006 study conducted by the Montana Department of Fish, Wildlife and Parks (FWP), researchers sought to determine if the proportion of trout afflicted by whirling disease in the Gallatin river differs between rainbow trout and brown trout. To test this theory, researchers collected a representative sample of 527 rainbow trout and 459 brown trout. Of the 527 rainbow trout collected, 120 had developed whirling disease; of the 459 brown trout collected, 74 had developed whirling disease.

2. Does whether a trout develops whirling disease appear to be associated with the species of trout (rainbow or brown)?

   (a) Yes, since the proportion of trout that developed the disease was not equal to 0.5.
   (b) Yes, since the conditional proportion of trout that developed the disease differed between rainbow and brown trout.
   (c) Yes, since the number of trout who developed whirling disease differed from the number of trout who did not develop whirling disease.
   (d) No, since approximately the same number of trout in each species were used.

   Correct answers: (b)

In a study on treatments for anorexia, researchers recruited 30 teenage girls with anorexia. The girls were ranked by weight prior to the study. Of the heaviest three girls, one was randomly assigned to a "family" therapy, one to a "cognitive/behavioral" therapy, and one to a control group. The same was done for the next three heaviest girls, down to the three lightest girls. After five weeks of treatment, researchers weighed the participants. Researchers would like to determine which, if any, of the treatments are most effective in treating anorexia. Use this scenario to answer questions **??** and **??**.

3. If the researchers found that there were statistically significant differences in average weight across the three treatments, would the researchers be justified in concluding that the treatments caused the changes in weights?

   (a) Yes, since the therapy group was randomly assigned.
   (b) Yes, since this was an observational study.
   (c) No, since weight was not randomly assigned.
   (d) No, since the researchers do not know which treatment was most effective.

   Correct answers: (a)

4. What type of study design did the researchers use?

   (a) Blocking study design
   (b) Matched pairs design
   (c) Completely randomized design
   (d) Observational study

   Correct answers: (a)

A study published in 2007 by Christopher Johnson, professor of music education and music therapy at the University of Kansas, revealed that students in elementary schools who took private music lessons scored around 20 percent higher in math scores on standardized tests, compared to students who did not take private music lessons.

5. Is this a randomized experiment or an observational study?

   (a) Observational study, since this was not a random sample.
   (b) Randomized experiment, since researchers gave students standardized tests.
   (c) Observational study, since math scores were not randomly assigned.
   (d) Observational study, since whether the student took private music lessons was not randomly assigned.

   Correct answers: (d)

Researchers randomly assigned patients with severe acne to one of two treatments: the standard topical antibiotic (the control) or a new antibiotic taken orally (the treatment). Six months later an evaluation of skin problems was made by a doctor who did not know which medication subjects had been given.

6. What is the primary advantage of random assignment of the treatment?

   (a) Random assignment ensures that the subject doesn't know which treatment they are getting.
   (b) Random assignment allows the researchers to infer that any difference in outcome was due to the treatments.
   (c) Random assignment ensures that the study participants are representative of the larger population.
   (d) Random assignment allows inference back to a population of patients with acne.

   Correct answers: (b)

The Women's Health Study included 39,876 female health professionals aged 45 years and older who were followed for an average of 10 years (Ridker et al., 2005). At the beginning of the study, participants were randomly assigned to take either a daily low-dose aspirin or a daily placebo pill for the duration of the study. At the end of the study, researchers measured the number of participants that suffered from a heart attack during the study. Data are summarized in the following table.

	Low-dose Aspirin	**Placebo**	**Total**
Heart Attack	198	193	391
No Heart Attack	19,736	19,749	39,485
Total	19,934	19,942	39,876

Use this scenario to answer questions **??**, **??**, and **??**.

7. What type of plot could be used to plot these data?

   (a) Histogram
   (b) Dotplot
   (c) Segmented bar chart
   (d) Scatterplot

   Correct answers: (c)

8. Calculate the relative risk of heart attack for the low-dose aspirin group compared to the placebo group.

   (a) 1.026
   (b) 0.00993
   (c) 0.000255
   (d) 0.974

   Correct answers: (a)

9. Do the data suggest an association exists between whether a woman takes low-dose Aspirin or placebo and if the woman suffers from a heart attack in this sample?

   (a) Yes, women who took low-dose Aspirin were more likely to suffer from a heart attack.
   (b) We cannot determine whether an association exists without a plot.
   (c) Yes, women who took low-dose Aspirin were less likely to suffer from a heart attack.
   (d) No, since approximately the same proportion of women suffered from a heart attack in each group.

   Correct answers: (d)

Recently, a Montana newspaper asked people to go to the newspaper's website and respond yes or no to the question: "Should federal protections on grizzly bears be lifted?" Of 933 opinions, 58.1% said "Yes", and 41.9% said either "No" or "Uncertain".

10. Is it valid to conclude from the poll that over half of all Montana residents favor lifting the protections?

    (a) No, because the sample is too small given the population of 75,000 Montana residents.
    (b) No, because the sample is not likely to be representative of the population.
    (c) Yes, because 58.1
    (d) Yes, because the sample size is large enough to represent all 75,000 Montana residents.

    Correct answers: (b)